

Preparing Your PDF for Submission, Including Accessibility Report(s)

In addition to following the UMKC formatting guidelines, UMKC authors of theses and dissertations (T/Ds) should meet digital accessibility requirements. Students will submit PDFs and accessibility report(s) of their T/Ds to the SGS.

The following are some resources for students to utilize and steps to take:

1. [UMKC Digital Accessibility Essentials](#)
2. Apply Microsoft Word's "Styles" Headings and other Styles
 - A. [Microsoft's Video: "Improve accessibility with heading styles"](#)
 - B. Headings created should be from main headings (e.g., ABSTRACT, LIST OF ILLUSTRATIONS, LIST OF TABLES, CHAPTERS, REFERENCES, VITA, etc.).
3. Describe images in the body of the text, captions, and alternative text (alt text)
4. In the Document Properties of the Word file complete the following:
 - A. Set language to English
 - B. Add your name as author
 - C. Add your T/D document title, so it matches your T/D title
5. Run the accessibility checker in Word, then fix all issues
 - A. Then save your Word file as a PDF or PDF/A
6. When saving your revised Word file to a PDF or PDF/A, select the following options:
 - A. Page range: All,
 - B. Publish what: Document,
 - C. Include non-printing information: Create bookmarks using Headings and Document structure tags for accessibility,
 - D. and PDF options: PDF/A compliant and Optimize for image quality.
7. Adobe Acrobat Pro: "[Create and verify PDF accessibility \(Acrobat Pro\)](#)"

- A. UMKC Information Services [Technology Resources](#) for students
- 8. Then follow these steps in Adobe Acrobat Pro on your T/D to check and fix issues:
 - A. All Tools > Prepare for accessibility > Check for accessibility > select these options:
 - 1. Check the boxes for the following:
 - a. Report Options: Create accessibility report
 - b. Page Range: All pages in document
 - c. Checking Options: Category Document and Select All 32 of 32 in all categories
 - d. Check the box for Show this dialog when the Checker starts
 - e. Click Start Checking, then review report and fix issues accordingly
 - B. Best practice: resolve accessibility issues in one's source document, then save it as a PDF and check and correct as needed to reach a Summary result with **0 problems detected**
- 9. When you submit your thesis or dissertation to the SGS for initial and final format review you will also need to **provide accessibility report(s)**
 - A. A PDF of the Adobe PDF Accessibility Report of your document is **required**
 - 1. The output of the report will be an HTML file that students will need to save as a PDF by Printing to PDF and saving
 - a. Note: The PDF report in this format will not be digitally accessible. However, students will only be sharing it with staff and faculty for internal use, and it will not be posted on a website, so this is acceptable to the SGS.
 - B. As of February 5, 2026, **it is recommended, but not required, that students also run the PAC checker** on their document and view the WCAG 2.2 report to fix the accessibility issues noted. It is suggested to also comply with the PDF/UA guidelines.
 - 1. Students' use of the PAC checker should only be done if using the **current** [downloadable PAC PC version](#). Students should **not** use web versions of accessibility checkers.
 - 2. While viewing the WCAG 2.2 report, students will need to use Adobe Acrobat Pro to fix the accessibility issues noted.
 - a. Students should continue this back-and-forth process until the PAC WCAG 2.2 report shows 100 percent compliance.

- C. At the initial format review step, when students submit the Preliminary Approval of Thesis or Dissertation Kuali form, students **are not required** to show their document has passed all criteria (32 of 32 Options in all categories of the document)
 - D. At the final format review step after the supervisory committee chair/primary advisor initiates the Thesis or Dissertation Final Approvals (of the written document) Kuali form, **students' Adobe PDF Accessibility Report must show their document has passed all criteria (32 of 32 Options in all categories of the document)**
10. It is recommended that students' final T/D submitted to ProQuest—after SGS certification—is either a PDF/A or PDF/UA file.
- A. Students will not submit accessibility reports of T/Ds to ProQuest.
11. Please see the [Submitting Your Thesis or Dissertation for Review](#) web page for more details on the T/D Format Review, Certification, and Submission Approval Process.
12. Please see the [Theses and Dissertations](#) web page for more information, including deadlines, formatting guidance resources, links to Kuali forms, and additional resources.